



MODULE 5

Building a Motivation Climate

What are you actually rewarding — winning or learning?

CORE THEORY

Achievement Goal Theory (Ames, 1992) distinguishes two climates: a mastery climate (focused on learning, progress, effort) and a performance climate (focused on winning, comparing, ranking). Research in youth sport consistently shows: players in a mastery climate have more fun, persist longer, make fewer anxiety-driven errors, and perform better long-term. The climate is created by the coach — through feedback, grouping, evaluation, and time investment.

Source: Ames (1992) · Nicholls (1989) · Smith, Smoll & Cumming (2007) · Ntoumanis & Biddle (1999)

"Tell me how you keep score, and I'll tell you how people will behave."

— Albert Ames

"In a growth climate, failure is not the opposite of success. It is part of it."

— Carol Dweck

SELF-REFLECTION

- 1 What is your first reaction when a team loses but played well? And when they win but played poorly?
- 2 How do you evaluate players? Based on effort and growth — or based on comparison with others?
- 3 What signals in your training show players that making mistakes is safe?
- 4 How do you talk about stronger players vs. weaker ones? What do others hear in that?
- 5 If you could choose tomorrow: a team that always wins but doesn't grow, or one that loses but improves every week — which do you choose? Why?

NOTES

**BOOKS**

- **Mindset**
Carol Dweck
Why: The definitive work on fixed vs. growth mindset. Chapters 4 and 5 focus specifically on sport and coaching.
- **Peak**
Anders Ericsson & Robert Pool
Why: Deliberate practice: how to build a climate where players truly learn. Based on 30 years of elite research.
- **The Culture Code**
Daniel Coyle
Why: How the world's best teams build a safe learning climate. Concrete lessons from Navy SEALs, Pixar, and the All Blacks.

**VIDEO'S / TED TALKS**

- **The Power of Believing That You Can Improve**
Carol Dweck (TED Talk)
ted.com/talks/carol_dweck_the_power_of_believing_that_you_can_improve
The "not yet" principle. Watch and decide: do you use this in your coaching?
- **How to Build a High Performing Team**
Daniel Coyle (Google Talk)
youtube.com/watch?v=KpSNGeDGDKA
Three ingredients of culture: safety signals, vulnerability loops, shared purpose.

**PODCASTS**

- **The Science of Sport**
Motivation climate in youth sport — what the science says
scienceofsport.com
- **Finding Mastery**
Episode with Carol Dweck — mindset in sport
findingmastery.com

⚡ ACTION THIS WEEK

Analyze your next training session: count how often you reward effort/process vs. how often you reward result/correctness. What will you change next time?

One concrete element in my training I will adjust to build a stronger mastery climate:
